Chinese control. This led to widespread student protests, not only in Beijing but in several other parts of China. These protests began in Beijing on 4 May 1919 and spread across the country. It became known as the May Fourth Movement. There was widespread debate over what lay at the root of China's weakness and what was required to make China a strong and modern nation. Should China find redemption by delving deep into the wellsprings of its own rich and long-standing civilization, or should it embrace Western values and modernity as another traditional society such as Meiji Japan had done? Should China embrace 'Mr Science and Mr Democracy', which the youth leaders of the May Fourth Movement argued for, or should it turn to the new and reformist ideas of Marxism-Leninism and draw both ideological inspiration and support from the newly established communist state of the Soviet Union next door? It is the interplay and contention of these ideas which would mark the first half of the twentieth century in China.

The 'century of humiliation', which ended with the liberation of China on 1 October 1949, is the subject we shall explore in the next chapter – a historical period that was also important in drawing the contours of China's contemporary image of India.

Inner Asia comprises the Central Asian domains of Tibet, Mongolia, the Tarim Basin and the oasis towns on its periphery, and Manchuria.

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